

QUICK TAKE The new Tadka platform on JioHotstar; (below) a show on Bullet app

MICRO DRAMAS ▼

SHORT ***AND SWEET***

With JioHotstar's launch of micro-content platform Tadka, short-form storytelling is going mainstream

Imagine settling in to watch a show and being done before you've even sunk into your seat. In under two minutes, the story unfolds, peaks, and leaves you wanting more. That's increasingly how entertainment is being consumed today—and JioHotstar's recently launched Tadka signals that this shift is well underway.

With over 100 micro shows going live on day one, the platform is making a clear bet on short-form storytelling as a mainstream format. Aimed at mobile-first viewers, Tadka offers vertical, episodic stories lasting 60 seconds to two minutes—suited to in-between moments, whether during a commute or a brief pause in the day.

The lineup spans multiple genres. There are high-stakes dramas like *Mitti Ka Sher*, *Section F Ka Only Boy* and *Rukega Nahin Saala*, thrillers such as *Undercover Boss–Scam Smash* and *Topper Bhai Ka Badla*, alongside romance and pop-culture-led titles like *Desi Influencerz–CEO vs. CEO*.

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For many in the industry, the significance of Tadka lies not just in its content, but in the scale at which it is being rolled out. As Jehangir Irroni, assistant vice president in Incut Digital Pvt Ltd's video division—a launch partner—notes, backing from a platform like JioHotstar could reshape how the format is perceived. "Stories that may have earlier struggled to find distribution or visibility now have a clear pathway to scale and sustain audience engagement," he says.

There is also a growing view that micro content could become a testing ground for new ideas. "Micro content is where the next generation of IP is going to be built and tested," says Sonya V. Kapoor, owner/partner at M5 Entertainment, another launch partner.

Bullet, a platform focused on high-frequency, vertical-format micro dramas, is also driving much of this transition behind the scenes. For Saurabh Kushwah, its co-founder and chief technology & product officer, the move towards micro storytelling reflects both changing audience behaviour and gaps in the content ecosystem. "Audiences today expect immediate engagement. If a story doesn't deliver within the first few seconds, they move on. Micro storytelling is a natural response to this behaviour; it respects the user's time while still delivering a complete emotional experience," he says.

Bullet's own content reflects this approach. From *Mom Talks*, a talk-led format with Parineeti Chopra that blends personal stories with expert insight, to fiction titles like *Garib Hai Chor Nahi* and *Khabri*, the focus is on high-emotion, tightly structured narratives.

Early signals suggest growing interest, with audiences sampling multiple episodes in a single sitting. As viewing habits adjust to tighter time constraints, it's perhaps only natural that storytelling follows suit. ■

—Deepa Natarajan Lobo